

Scallion / Green Onion Grow Guide

For scallion, green onion, and spring onion style harvests

ParaLife Trees	Planting a Life in Paradise
WhatsApp	1 (876) 372-7415
Guide focus	Transplanting • Spacing • Watering • Feeding • Pests • Diseases • Harvesting

This guide is written for customers planting seedlings from trays or small pots into containers, raised beds, backyard gardens, and small farm plots.

Quick Rescue Page: If You See This, Do This

What You See	Most Likely Cause	What To Do First
White/silver streaks on leaves	Onion thrips feeding damage	Inspect leaf folds; rinse or spray under leaves; repeat every 3-5 days; remove badly damaged leaves.
Leaves turning pale/yellow	Low nitrogen, water stress, old leaves, or root problem	Check soil moisture; feed lightly; improve drainage if soil stays wet.
Tips drying or browning	Heat, dry soil, fertilizer burn, or salt buildup	Water evenly; avoid strong fertilizer; mulch lightly; flush containers if needed.
Plant rotting at base	Too much water, poor drainage, bacterial soft rot, or fungal disease	Remove rotten plants; improve airflow/drainage; avoid splashing soil on leaves.
Leaves collapsing after transplant	Transplant shock, dry roots, or hot sun	Water immediately; shade 1-2 days; transplant early morning or late evening.
Leaves have holes or cut stems	Cutworms, caterpillars, slugs/snails, grasshoppers	Check evening/early morning; remove pests; use collars or barriers.
Purple/gray fuzzy growth on leaves	Downy mildew in humid/wet weather	Remove affected leaves; improve spacing; water at soil level; avoid wet leaves overnight.
Orange/rusty spots	Rust disease	Remove affected leaves; improve airflow; avoid overcrowding.
Bulb/base not swelling	Too crowded or harvested young as scallion	For spring onion, space 4-6 inches and let it grow longer.
Tall flower stalk forming	Bolting from age, stress, or temperature shift	Harvest soon; texture/flavour declines after bolting.

Important: scallion and green onion are normally sold as the same crop. Spring onion is usually grown longer so the base swells more.

Quick Numbers Page

Item	Specific Range / Target
Crop names for guide	Scallion / Green Onion / Spring Onion
Common crop group	Allium; often Allium fistulosum or young Allium cepa
Seed germination	6-12 days in warm, moist conditions
Transplant age from seed	6-8 weeks after sowing, or pencil-thin/strong enough to handle
Hardening off	5-7 days before field planting
Scallion harvest after transplant	30-45 days for green onion size
Green onion harvest from seed	40-60 days
Spring onion harvest after transplant	45-75 days, depending on swelling desired
Full sun target	6+ hours daily; light afternoon shade can help in very hot conditions
Soil pH target	6.0-7.0
Water target	About 1 inch / 25 mm per week; more frequent in containers or dry heat
Scallion spacing	2-3 inches apart in-row
Spring onion spacing	4-6 inches apart in-row
Row spacing	10-15 inches for small beds; 12-18 inches for easier field work
Container depth	6-8 inches minimum

Market wording tip: label the crop as “Scallion / Green Onion.” Add “can be grown longer as spring onion” when customers want a bigger base.

Hardening Off Seedlings Before Transplanting

Hardening off means slowly preparing tray seedlings for direct sun, wind, and outdoor conditions before planting them into the garden or field.

Day	Exposure
Day 1-2	Bright shade for 2-3 hours; keep tray moist.
Day 3-4	Morning sun for 2-4 hours; return to shade before harsh midday sun.
Day 5-6	Morning sun plus bright afternoon shade; avoid drying out tray cells.
Day 7	Ready to transplant, preferably early morning or late evening.

- Do not move seedlings straight from shade into full hot sun.
- Tray cells dry quickly; check moisture morning and evening during hardening off.
- If seedlings wilt badly, move them back to shade and water gently.
- Avoid fertilizing heavily during hardening off; focus on moisture and gradual sun exposure.

Transplanting From Trays or Small Pots

Best transplanting times are before 8:30 a.m. or after 4:30 p.m. In hot weather, evening transplanting gives roots the night to settle.

Step	What To Do
1	Water the tray 1-2 hours before transplanting.
2	Prepare the bed, rows, or container before removing seedlings.
3	Make holes deep enough for the roots, but do not bury the green leaves.
4	Lift seedlings gently; keep roots moist and shaded.
5	Plant upright with the white base/root section covered and green leaves above soil.
6	Press soil gently around roots. Do not compact heavily.
7	Water immediately after planting.
8	Shade for 1-2 days if the sun is harsh or plants are wilting.
9	Check morning and evening for the first 3-5 days.

Transplant depth: bury the root section and lower white stem only. Keep the green leaf base above soil to reduce rot.

Spacing Guide

Use	Plant Spacing	Row Spacing
Scallion / Green onion	2-3 inches apart	10-15 inches
Spring onion with small bulb/base	4-6 inches apart	12-18 inches
Small farmer hand-weeding rows	3-4 inches apart	12-18 inches
Container growing	2-4 inches apart	Container width decides row spacing
Bunch harvest	Plant closer; harvest whole bunch younger	10-12 inches

Sunlight, Soil, and Water

Need	Target / Action
Sunlight	6+ hours daily for strong upright leaves.
Hot conditions	Light afternoon shade from about 12 p.m.-3 p.m. can reduce stress.
Soil texture	Loose, fertile, well-draining soil.
Soil pH	6.0-7.0.
Organic matter	Add compost before planting.
Mulch	Use light mulch to reduce drying, but keep it off the stem base.
Drainage	Water should not sit around roots.

Watering Guide

Stage	Watering Direction
First 3-5 days after transplant	Check morning and evening; keep soil evenly moist.
Established plants	Water when the top 1 inch of soil begins to dry.
Dry/hot weather	Water more often; containers may need daily checks.
Rainy periods	Reduce watering and improve drainage to avoid rot.
Best method	Water at soil level; avoid keeping leaves wet overnight.

Feeding Guide

Scallion/green onion is grown mainly for leaves, so it needs steady mild nitrogen, but not strong fertilizer that burns roots or makes soft weak leaves.

Stage	Timing	Feeding Direction
At transplanting	Day 0	Compost mixed into bed or container.
After settling	7-10 days after transplant	Light liquid feed or mild balanced fertilizer.
Active leaf growth	Every 14-21 days	Light nitrogen support if leaves are pale.
Spring onion swelling stage	After 30-45 days	Keep moisture even; avoid overdoing nitrogen.
Final week before harvest	Last 7 days	Avoid heavy feeding; focus on clean water and harvest quality.

Avoid overfeeding: strong fertilizer can cause burned tips, soft growth, poor storage, and more pest/disease pressure.

Leaf Color and Problem Guide

Leaf Look	Possible Cause	What To Do
Deep green, upright leaves	Healthy growth	Continue steady water and light feeding.
Pale green leaves	Low nitrogen, poor roots, or low sunlight	Feed lightly; improve sunlight; check root moisture.
Yellow leaves	Overwatering, old leaves, or nutrient stress	Check drainage; remove old leaves; feed lightly.
Dry brown tips	Heat, dry soil, fertilizer burn, salt buildup	Water evenly; reduce fertilizer; flush containers.
Silver/white streaks	Thrips feeding	Inspect leaf folds; treat early.
Soft slimy base	Rot from wet soil or poor airflow	Remove affected plants; improve drainage and spacing.

Common Pests: Fast Identification and Action

Onion Thrips

- White/silver streaks, scarred leaves, tiny insects hiding between leaves.
- Worst when weather is hot/dry and plants are stressed.
- Spray or rinse into leaf folds; repeat every 3-5 days; remove badly damaged leaves; keep plants watered.

Cutworms

- Seedlings cut off near soil line, usually overnight.
- Use collars around young seedlings; check soil surface in evening/early morning.

Slugs and Snails

- Ragged holes and slime trails, worse after rain or at night.
- Remove hiding places; lift containers; handpick; use safe bait/barriers.

Onion Maggot / Root Maggot

- Weak plants, wilting, damaged roots or base.
- Remove affected plants; rotate planting area; avoid planting in infested soil repeatedly.

Leafminers

- Thin winding lines or mines inside leaves.
- Remove affected leaves; keep weeds down; use insect netting where pressure is high.

Aphids / Whiteflies

- Sticky leaves, curling, insects under leaves.
- Spray under leaves; repeat every 3-5 days; manage ants and weeds.

Common Diseases: Fast Identification and Action

Downy Mildew

- Purple-gray fuzzy growth on leaves; yellowing then browning tissue.
- Worse in humid, wet, crowded conditions.
- Improve spacing; water early at soil level; remove affected leaves.

Rust

- Orange or rusty spots/pustules on leaves.
- Remove affected leaves; improve airflow; avoid crowding and wet foliage.

Purple Blotch / Leaf Blight

- Purple/brown lesions, leaf dieback, worse after leaf damage or wet conditions.
- Remove debris; rotate crops; avoid overhead watering; manage thrips.

Bacterial Soft Rot

- Soft, wet, smelly rot at base or leaves.
- Remove affected plants; reduce moisture; avoid damaging plants during harvest.

Basal Rot / Root Rot

- Yellowing, wilting, poor roots, rotting base.
- Improve drainage; avoid soggy soil; rotate planting location.

Damping Off

- Young seedlings collapse at soil line.
- Use clean trays/mix; avoid overwatering; improve airflow.

Customer note: most disease problems become worse when plants are too crowded, leaves stay wet overnight, or soil remains waterlogged.

Harvesting Guide

Harvest Type	Timing / Method
Scallion / Green onion whole plant	Harvest 30-45 days after transplant when 8-12 inches tall.
Cut-and-come-again greens	Cut green leaves 1-2 inches above the base; regrowth can begin within 7-14 days.
Spring onion	Allow 45-75 days after transplant or until the base swells to the size wanted.
Bunch harvest for market	Harvest early morning; wash roots/base; keep cool and shaded.
Home kitchen harvest	Cut leaves as needed, or pull the whole plant for cooking.

For clean bunches: harvest early morning, remove old leaves, rinse with clean water, drain well, and keep out of direct sun.

Bolting and Flower Stalks

- Bolting means the plant is shifting from leaf/base growth into flowering.
- Signs: tall firm center stalk, stronger flavor, tougher leaves.
- Common triggers: age, heat stress, transplant stress, and temperature changes.
- Action: harvest soon if eating quality matters; leave a few plants only if saving seed.

Small Farmer Notes

- Plant in straight rows for easier weeding and harvesting.
- Use 3-4 inches between plants for good scallion bunch size.
- Use 12-18 inches between rows for hand work and airflow.
- Plant in batches every 7-14 days for continuous sales.
- Scout for thrips weekly; thrips damage is especially visible on green onions.
- Avoid planting onion family crops in the same bed repeatedly; rotate when possible.
- Harvest and wash in clean water; keep bunches shaded and cool after harvest.

Home Garden Notes

- For 2-6 plants, use a pot at least 6-8 inches deep with drainage holes.
- Space plants 2-4 inches apart for green onion harvest.
- Cut leaves as needed and allow regrowth.
- For spring onion size, give 4-6 inches spacing and allow more time.
- Keep pots in sun or bright light; water when the top 1 inch begins to dry.

Clean Handling and Seedling Sanitation

Before handling seedlings, wash hands with soap and water. Keep tools, trays, and containers clean. Do not handle rotten/diseased plants and then touch healthy plants without washing first.

- Do not plant into soil that recently had serious onion-family disease.
- Remove dead leaves and plant debris from the bed.
- Avoid harvesting or pruning when leaves are wet if disease is present.
- Use clean water for washing harvested scallions/green onions.
- Keep harvested bunches off the ground.

Need Help With Your Plants?

Send clear photos of: the full plant, damaged leaves, the base/root area, the underside/folded leaves, and any insects you see.

ParaLife Trees Support	
WhatsApp	1 (876) 372-7415
Brand line	Planting a Life in Paradise

Sources consulted for crop guidance: Purdue Extension FoodLink green onion/scallion harvest ranges; WSU Extension onion spacing/harvest ranges; Illinois Extension onion spacing for green onion harvest; UC IPM onion/garlic pest and disease identification; UC ANR green onion production pest/disease guidance; Oregon State Extension bunching onion pest/disease list.